

Good gut, good life.

Maslow

Self-actualization

Good gut, good life

Esteem

Streaks, leaderboard, the dopamine layer

Belonging

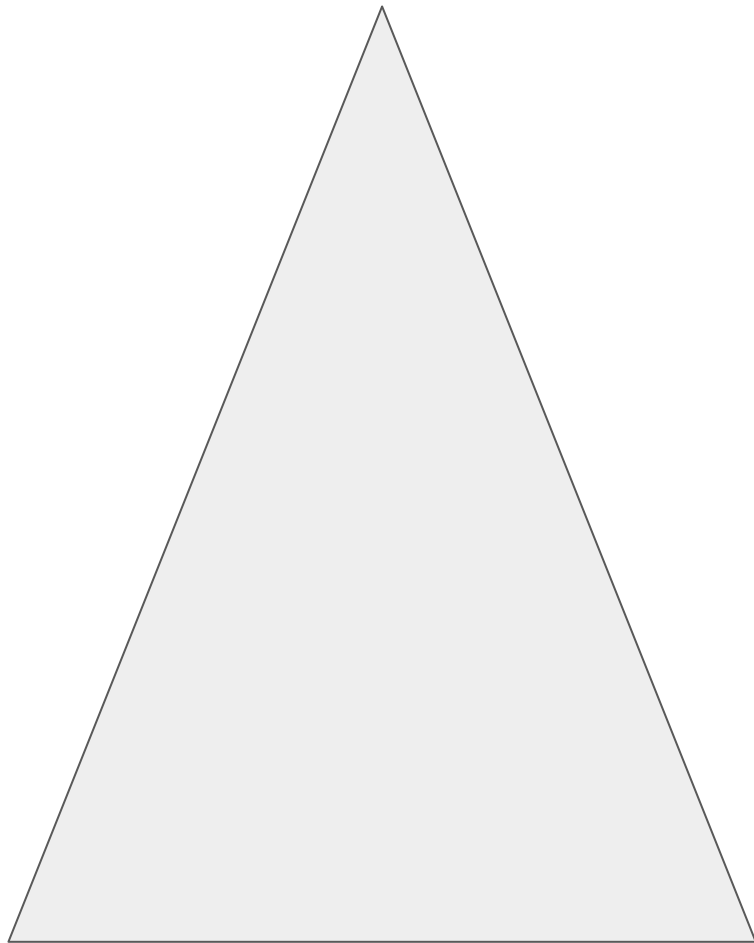
Shared ritual, the leaderboard and shared ritual of (we're all chasing 30)

Safety

Long-term gut health (microbiome diversity, the science)

Physiological

Eat 30 different plants



Brand promise

is it specific?

is it true?

is it for someone in particular?

and can you keep saying it without flinching?

Eat 30 different plants a week. Good gut, good life!

- **Specific:** 30 plants, one week. Countable. The app literally measures it.
- **True:** You're not claiming a cure. You're naming a behavior and an aspiration.
- **For someone in particular:** People who believe food is connected to how they feel and want a simple, gamified way to act on that belief.
- **Consistent:** Every surface of the product can say it — the login screen already does ("Track 30 plants a week. Good gut, good life."), the manifest does, the home ring enforces it, the advice engine reinforces it. Nothing in your product contradicts the promise.

This shows in...

Home screen → ring shows progress to 30 ✓

Log tab → makes adding a plant frictionless ✓ (this is the core promise being kept)

Advice → unlocks because you hit 30, reinforcing the behavior ✓

Leaderboard → social proof that others are doing it ✓

Notifications, copy, emails → do they all point at "30 plants this week"?

The places consistency usually breaks: onboarding (does it explain the promise in the first 10 seconds?), empty states (do they nudge toward the 30?), and re-engagement (when someone lapses, does the message return them to the promise, not to generic "we miss you"?).

Brand pillars

Count, don't preach

Different beats more

Effortless in the moment, meaningful by Sunday

Joy, not guilt

Pillar 1 —Count, don't preach

The principle

Most gut-health brands explain. We count. The number is the product. "30 different plants this week" is something a five-year-old can understand and a nutrition scientist can defend. We don't lecture about microbiomes, fiber types, or fermentation pathways — we hand people a number and let the number do the teaching.

The proof

The home screen is a ring counting to 30. The leaderboard ranks by unique plants. The advice unlocks when you hit 30. The app store description leads with the number. Every surface answers the same question: how many different plants this week?

The rules

- We never add a "Learn about your microbiome" content section.
- We never explain prebiotics, polyphenols, or short-chain fatty acids in the UI. (The AI advice can mention them naturally when relevant, but they're never the headline.)
- We never replace the number with a vaguer score (a "gut health index," a percentage, a letter grade). The number is 0–30. That's it.

Quote-worthy line - The number is the product.

Pillar 2 — Different beats more

The principle

Microbiome diversity follows plant diversity, not plant volume. So the count rewards variety — each plant counts once per week, no matter how often you eat it. This isn't a rule about how you cook; it's a rule about what we measure. Eat that kale three days in a row, in three different dishes — totally normal. The variety just shows up in what you pair it with: the seeds on top, the herbs in the dressing, the grain underneath, the fruit alongside. One ingredient stretched across the week is fine. One ingredient alone across the week is the thing variety quietly fixes.

The proof

Each plant counts once per week toward the 30. The advice engine surfaces what's missing, not what's repeated. Stats split by category so the user can see the shape of their week — heavy on fruit, light on legumes — and adjust naturally. The leaderboard ranks unique plants tried, all-time, so trying new things has lasting value beyond a single week.

The rules

- We count each plant once per week. Always. That's what makes 30 mean something.
- We never reward volume or weight (no "you ate 2kg of vegetables this week").
- We never frame repetition as failure. Eating kale three times this week isn't a problem — it's groceries. The app just doesn't reward you three times for it.
- We always make the missing as visible as the filled, so variety becomes the next easy choice — not a guilt trip.

Quote-worthy line - Each plant counts once. What you do with it is up to you.

Pillar 3 — Effortless in the moment, meaningful by Sunday

The principle

The friction lives in single taps spread across seven days, never in a "log your week" chore. You ate a strawberry, you tap a strawberry — three seconds, no thought. By Sunday, the count is real because every tap was real. This is how the app changes behavior unconsciously: people aren't tracking their diet, they're tapping plants. The result shows up on its own.

The proof

Tap-to-log from a searchable list of 150+ plants. No weighing, no portions, no macros, no calorie fields. Today's plants visible on the home screen as a reminder of what's already been captured. The week assembles itself.

The rules

- We never ask the user to recall what they ate yesterday or last week.
- We never add weight, portion, calorie, or macro fields.
- We never add a "log your week" or "weekly check-in" feature that depends on memory.
- We never punish a missed day. (A skipped day is just an empty tap, not a broken streak.)
- We always default to "right now" — the easiest tap should always be what I'm eating today.

Quote-worthy line - Tap as you eat. Count by the week.

Pillar 4 — Joy, not guilt

The principle

Food is one of the few daily pleasures that everyone has. We refuse to turn it into homework. No red foods, no shame numbers, no "you're falling behind." Project Food celebrates what you ate, never scolds what you didn't. The goal is to make eating well feel like a game you're winning — because for most people, it already is, they just can't see it.

The proof

Emoji-driven plant cards. SuperFood badges as gentle highlights, never as scolds. Advice phrased as suggestions ("try adding kefir") not corrections ("you're missing probiotics"). when you hit 30. A leaderboard that ranks high scores, not low ones. No diet labels (keto, low-carb, low-FODMAP) anywhere in the UI.

The rules

- We never use shame mechanics: no "you've failed this week," no red warning states, no negative streaks.
- We never use diet-culture language: no "cheat," "clean," "guilty," "naughty," "indulgent."
- We never compare a user's count to a target in a way that feels like falling short. "22/30, 8 to go" is fine. "You're 8 short — try harder" is not.
- We never rank or expose what a user didn't eat in a way that reads as judgment. ("Not yet tried" is curiosity. "Failed to try" is judgment. Wording matters.)
- We always lead with what they did, not what they didn't.

Quote-worthy line - Good food, good week, good life. Never homework.

Why people talk about us

The principle

Word-of-mouth happens when using the product is visible, surprising, and worth a story. Most food apps fail this test because they're private and predictable — nobody pulls out MyFitnessPal at dinner to show a friend. Project Food has three moments where the app earns a story, not because we ask for one, but because the moment itself is remarkable. Three moments people talk about

1. The plant they'd never heard of.

The advice engine suggests sumac, kohlrabi, or fennel pollen, and the user goes "what even is this?" — then buys it, eats it, posts it. Curiosity is the most contagious feeling on the internet. Every novel plant is a small story.

2. The 30/30 week.

Hitting 30 is a real accomplishment — most people don't realize how many different plants that actually is until they try. The screen celebrates. The leaderboard updates. People screenshot. "I ate 30 different plants this week" is the kind of casual humblebrag that travels naturally on Instagram, in group chats, in conversations.

3. The restaurant moment. (roadmap)

Out with friends, snap the menu, the AI surfaces which dishes pack the most plants — and which ones add plants you've never logged before. The table notices. "Wait, what is that app?" This is the public, social, conversation-starting moment most food apps never get. The rule

We never beg for word-of-mouth (no "rate us 5 stars" popups, no referral bribes). We design moments worth talking about. Then we get out of the way.

Quote-worthy line - The best marketing is a user pointing at their phone.

What people would miss if we were gone

The principle

Stickiness isn't "good gut, good life" — that payoff is too distant and too diffuse to drive daily return. Stickiness is what becomes annoying when it's absent. If Project Food disappeared tomorrow, two specific things would get harder, and that's where the moat lives.

Two voids

1. Sunday gets harder. (partially shipped, growing)

Every week, the user gets a personalized read on what's missing — by nutrient, by category, by season — and a small grocery list that fills the gaps. Without us, that decision goes back to "I don't know, the usual?" The app removes one recurring weekly decision. People miss what removes friction more than they miss what adds delight.

2. Eating out gets quieter. (roadmap)

With us, the restaurant becomes an opportunity to try plants you'd never cook at home — and the table conversation that comes with it. Without us, dinner out is just dinner out again.

The underlying answer

People don't miss us for the count. They miss us because once a week, the app makes a decision they no longer have to make alone — and once in a while, it turns a meal with friends into a small game worth playing. The 30 is what gets people in. The weekly utility is what keeps them.

The rule

We invest in the recurring moments, not the one-time delights. A feature that wows once but isn't used again is worth less than a feature that quietly removes friction every Sunday for two years.

Quote-worthy line - Without us, Sunday gets harder.